Datathon 2025

Official Handbook

@Datathon 2025

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1. Overview

Datathon is a small-scale initiative by UMDAC to introduce machine learning in an accessible format for all students. The event encourages students to apply fundamental ML techniques to real datasets, fostering early exposure to data-driven problem-solving and teamwork. This initiative also aims to bridge the gap between classroom learning and real-world application.

2. Competition Structure

2.1. Schedule

2.1.1. There are a total of two competition rounds for Datathon 2025, namely, the Preliminary Round and the Final Round.

Date	Activity
14 December 2025, Sunday	Online Workshop
19-20 December 2025, Friday - Saturday	Opening ceremony Competition Briefing Competition Starts Mentor Session
20 December 2025, Sunday	Competition Ends
26 December 2025, Friday	Physical Pitching Session Closing Ceremony

2.2. Workshop

2.2.1. An **online workshop** will be held on 14 December 2025 with topics related to Data Science and Analytics, equipping the participants with valuable skills for the Datathon.

2.2.2. This workshop is open for anyone to join.

2.2.3. The attendance to the workshop is not compulsory but highly encouraged as the participants can learn more about the Datathon in general aside from the workshop materials.

2.3. Preliminary Round

2.3.1. The Dataset and Problem Statement will only be revealed at the start of the Preliminary Round.

2.3.2. The **submission deadline** is on **20 December 2025, 7.40 PM.**

2.3.3. Submission for this round will require **a presentation slide** in PDF format showcasing the team's finding and solution based on the analysis and research conducted. (Maximum 10 pages)

2.3.4. Participants must include **a dashboard in pdf format** containing relevant information such as charts, graphs and key insights as part of their submission. (Maximum 5 pages)

2.3.5. Participants must submit **a pitching/presentation video** in MP4 or MOV format explaining the problem, key findings and proposed solution. (5-8 minutes)

2.3.6. The **scoring rubric will be shared during the competition briefing.**

2.3.7. The finalist teams will be announced on **23 December 2025**.

2.3.8. Only the teams that are able to attend the physical **Final Round** on **26 December** will be counted into the finalist selection process.

2.4. Final Round

2.4.1. Only **10 teams** will be selected to advance to the final round.

2.4.2. The final round would be a physical pitching in the **Faculty of Computer Science and Information Technology, University Malaya** on **26 December 2025**. Further details shall be relayed after the preliminary round.

2.4.3. Participants who qualify for the finals are responsible for covering their own travel expenses to **Faculty of Computer Science and Information Technology, University Malaya**

2.4.4. The **submission deadline** is on **25 December 11.59 PM.**

2.4.5. Submission components:

A) Product submission

- Participants are required to submit presentation slides (Must be in **PDF** Format) as the primary deliverable.
- Refinements to the solution are allowed before final submission to ensure quality and relevance
- All submission materials must be organised and uploaded to a designated Google Form.

2.4.6. On the Pitching Day (**26 December 2025**), the selected teams are given **5 minutes to pitch their product and solutions and a 10 minutes Q & A session** with the judging panel.

2.5. Submissions

2.5.1. All submissions and work products must be exclusively created by registered team members during the official Datathon period. The use of pre-existing code, models, or analysis must be clearly cited and must comply with their respective licences. External public resources such as documentation, Stack Overflow, or public APIs may be consulted, but direct code copying should be minimal and properly attributed.

2.5.2. If any instances of plagiarism are discovered in the submitted answer, the relevant participant will be disqualified from Datathon 2025.

2.5.3. No late submissions will be accepted, nor will incomplete, incorrect, erroneous, fraudulent, counterfeit, or manipulated submissions be considered.

3. Dataset Usage Restrictions

3.1. Participants must only use data provided by the organisers and/or approved public datasets specified inside these guidelines. Any external datasets must be:

- Publicly accessible and properly cited.
- Free from copyright restrictions or used with appropriate licence.
- Disclosed in the team's documentation and final submission.

3.2. The following data usage practices are strictly prohibited:

- Use of private or proprietary datasets without explicit permission.
- Scraping or collecting data in violation of terms of service.
- Using datasets containing sensitive identifiable personal information.
- Sharing competition datasets with non-participants.
- Using the provided datasets for purposes outside of Datathon

4. Certificates and Prizes

4.1. Following the participation in Datathon 2025, an e-certificate of participation will be awarded to all participants.

4.2. The above-mentioned e-certificate will be sent out to participants by Datathon 2025 Organiser by email

4.3. Award of cash prizes will be credited to a specified bank account provided the Team Leader of the winners.

4.4. Datathon 2025 accepts no responsibility for the loss of prize if the wrong bank account and details are provided by participants. Participants shall take full responsibility for confirming the correct bank account and details given

4.5. The prize is offered with no liability on the part of Datathon 2025 organiser as to how the award will be divided among the team members.

5. Ideas & Intellectual Property

5.1. All participants will retain full rights over their ideas for the prototype, slides produced for pitching purposes.

5.2. The Datathon 2025 organiser will not have the power to disenfranchise any ideas that are presented by the participants on their submission of the pitching slides and the app developed (if any).

5.3. Ownership of the dashboard (if any) and ideas of the submitted pitching slides and solutions developed (if any) will remain as participants' in all circumstances.

5.4. The pitching slides submitted will be used only for the purpose of Datathon 2025

6. General Terms and Condition

6.1. The organiser of Datathon 2025 maintains the right to modify these terms and conditions at any moment and without notice.

6.2. If any participant violates the terms and conditions of Datathon 2025, the organiser reserves the right to take any action towards the participant.

6.3. These terms and conditions are governed by Malaysian law, and participants consent to the exclusive jurisdiction of Malaysian courts.

6.4. All relevant federal, state, and local rules and regulations apply to this event. Where restricted, this offer is void.

6.5. The Datathon 2025 organiser reserves the right to contact any of the Participants at any time for more information or to explore possible collaborations opportunities.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Datathon 2025

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Frequently Asked Questions

1. **What is Datathon 2025?**

   Datathon 2025 is a competitive data analytics event where participants analyse datasets, uncover insights, and propose solutions to real-world problems using data science techniques.

2. **Who is the organiser of Datathon 2025 ?**

   The event is organised by the **Universiti Malaya Data Analytics Club (UMDAC)**.

3. **When will Datathon 2025 be held ?**

   I. 14 December 2025 – Online Workshop

   Ii. 19–20 December 2025 – Opening Ceremony & Online Competition

   Iii. 26 December 2025 – Final Round & Closing Ceremony (Physical)

4. **What is the mode of execution for Datathon 2025?**

   Datathon 2025 is conducted in **hybrid mode**, with online sessions via Microsoft Teams, WhatsApp, and Discord, and physical sessions at FCSIT, Universiti Malaya.

5. **Where will the physical round take place?**

   The final round will be held at **Dewan Kuliah 1 (DK1)** and **Bilik Kuliah 1 (BK1)** at FCSIT, University of Malaya.

6. **Who is eligible to join Datathon 2025 ?**

   The competition is open to all university students across Malaysia, regardless of field of study.

7. **Is the competition individual or team-based?**

   Participants may join **individually or as a team**.

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8. **How many members are allowed in a team ?**

   Minimum 1, Maximum 3.

9. **Can I change my team members after registration?**

   No. Team changes are **not allowed** after submission.

10. **How do I register for Datathon 2025?**

    Participants register by filling in the official Datathon 2025 form, which will be shared via Datathon social media platforms.

11. **Is attendance for the workshop compulsory?**

    Participants are encouraged to join as it provides essential foundational skills.

12. **When is the dataset and problem statement revealed?**

    The problem statement and dataset will be revealed on **19 December 2025** during the opening ceremony.

13. **How long is the competition duration?**

    The competition runs for 20 hours, ending on 20 December 2025.

14. **Will datasets be provided?**

    Yes, an official dataset will be provided by the organisers.

15. **Can participants use external datasets?**

    Unless announced otherwise, participants should use the **officially provided dataset** for fairness.

16. **Are mentors available during the event?**

    Yes. Mentor sessions will be held during the online competition period as stated in the

programme flow.

17. What will happen during the final round?

Finalists will deliver their pitching, attend sponsor sessions, and participate in the closing ceremony.

18. Will food and drinks be provided during the physical sessions?

Ok Yes, food and beverages will be provided for finalists, judges, VIPs, and the committee.

19. Will transportation be provided?

No. Participants must arrange their own transportation to University of Malaya.

20. Is there a dress code for the event?

No strict dress code is listed, but participants are encouraged to dress appropriately, especially for the pitching session.

21. Can we observe other teams' final presentations?

No. As with most data competitions, pitching sessions will be private between teams and judges.

Who should participants contact if they have question(s) that are not addressed in the FAQ list?

Participants should reach out to the management of UMDAC Datathon.

Email: umdac@um.edu.my

Contact Information:

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